

### 8.2.3 Release on request

Applications to the Import Station in triplicate on the official notepaper of the Representative must bear the official stamp of the Mission or Body concerned and must be signed by the Head of the Mission or Body or the Principal Consular Representative. Lists of persons entitled to diplomatic privilege are supplied by the Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade (DFA) and copies are circulated to all officials concerned in ports and airports. The DFA are to be consulted in cases of doubt. Otherwise, the forms of application are to be noted 'allowed', signed, and stamped. The original and a copy of the form are to be forwarded to the officer at the import office and when clearance has been allowed the forms are to be endorsed with the date and time of clearance, signed and stamped. The original is to be retained on file at the import office and the other copy returned to the Mission or Body or the Principal Consular Representative.

Where an application is received from a person whose name is not on the list, Protocol 2 Section, Protocol Division, Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade - Tel: +353 1 408 2356/408 2344 is to be contacted for clarification.

### 8.2.4 Personal baggage

The personal baggage of diplomatic agents, Consular Officers, the Secretary General of the UN, all Assistant Secretaries-General of the UN, the Executive Head of each Specialised Agency of the UN and families of the above-mentioned is not to be examined unless there are serious grounds for suspecting that it contains articles not covered by the exemptions listed or articles that are subject to prohibition or restriction. Examinations should be carried out only following consultation with the relevant Assistant Principal and should be made in the presence of the person concerned.

### 8.2.5 Contents of packages unknown

Where the contents of a package are unknown, facilities are to be afforded, on request, for the opening of the package in the presence of an officer by a member of the Mission concerned, but delivery is not to be allowed until the completed form of application has been received.

### 8.2.6 Motor vehicles

[Instructions relating to motor vehicles](#) are contained in the Revenue website.

Since 1 January 2021, arising from the UK Withdrawal Agreement and the end of the transitional period there are significant implications of importing vehicles from Great Britain and Northern Ireland. Most used vehicles imported into the State from overseas are sourced in the UK.